

12 Using discourse markers

Discourse markers can be used to show a relationship between two sentences, or parts of a sentence. This can be cause, effect, emphasis, contrast, or comparison.

⚙️ **New language** Linking information

Aa **Vocabulary** Family history

🧩 **New skill** Talking about relationships

12.1 KEY LANGUAGE INFORMAL LINKING DISCOURSE MARKERS

Some discourse markers are mostly used in informal writing and speech.

TIP
To emphasize the relationship between words when speaking, you can add stress to the discourse marker.



I like listening to music, **but** my mother hates it.

Shows contrast.



He's a talented swimmer, **like** his great-grandfather was.

Shows comparison.



Staying in touch is easy, **because** we all have smartphones.

Shows result.



We grew up together, **so** we tell each other everything. We are very close. **As a result**, we know everything about each other.

Shows effect.



All my siblings are tall, **especially** my older sister.

Shows emphasis.

